PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Extended Detection and Response (XDR) and Detection Engineering Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, building and maintaining Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platforms across hybrid cloud and endpoint environments. I specialise in detection engineering, writing advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL) detections in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM to surface high-fidelity threats, and developing Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that automate repetitive analyst tasks and accelerate response. My background spans Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender (Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Defender for Cloud Apps), CrowdStrike Falcon and PowerShell scripting, and I bring strong experience in cloud security architecture across Microsoft Azure environments. I am comfortable working independently and collaboratively in a remote or hybrid capacity, and I am passionate about building detection and response capabilities that keep organisations one step ahead of adversaries.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel (primary), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk (SPL), IBM QRadar
- **XDR and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** Microsoft Defender XDR (Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Cloud Apps), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Prevent
- **Detection Engineering:** Advanced KQL query writing in Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Query Language (CQL), MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules, threat intelligence-driven alerting
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps playbooks, CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR, PowerShell scripting, automated triage and enrichment workflows
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security architecture, Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access, cloud security posture management, hybrid cloud environments
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework, digital forensics, containment, eradication and post-incident review
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Other:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast, Tanium, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Design, build and maintain SIEM and XDR detection capabilities across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, ensuring comprehensive visibility across cloud, endpoint and identity threat surfaces for over 8,000 users.
- Engineer and tune detection rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, writing advanced KQL queries in Microsoft Sentinel and CQL in CrowdStrike to surface high-fidelity detections with minimal false positives.
- Develop SOAR automation playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR, automating alert triage, indicator enrichment and response actions including account isolation and ticket creation.
- Conduct cloud security architecture reviews across Microsoft Azure environments, identifying security gaps and recommending controls aligned to the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) and CIS Controls.
- Lead incident response operations from initial detection and analysis through containment, eradication and post-incident review, following NIST 800-61 procedures and documenting lessons learned.

- Perform proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, identifying adversarial activity and lateral movement that bypasses automated detection controls.
- Collaborate with platform and infrastructure teams to integrate new data sources into the SIEM, maintaining high-quality log coverage and minimising detection blind spots.
- Write and maintain PowerShell scripts to automate security operations tasks including log parsing, vulnerability reporting and configuration compliance checking.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Supported the deployment and ongoing optimisation of Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across a hybrid Microsoft 365 and Azure environment, managing alert triage and incident escalation workflows.
- Authored and tuned KQL detection rules and analytics queries within Microsoft Sentinel, reducing false positive rates and improving the accuracy of high-severity alert generation.
- Assisted in building SOAR playbooks to automate common response tasks, freeing analyst capacity for complex investigations and threat hunting activities.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID identity security controls, including Conditional Access policy design, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enforcement and privileged identity management, reducing identity-based attack risk.
- Performed vulnerability management assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, tracking critical and high findings through to remediation and reporting on risk reduction to management.
- Supported integration of threat intelligence feeds into Microsoft Sentinel, enriching alerts with contextual indicators of compromise (IOCs) and tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs) to accelerate analyst decision-making.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

- Provided security engineering support across SaaS and infrastructure environments, covering endpoint protection, vulnerability management and access control.
- Implemented and maintained security tooling for endpoint protection, log monitoring and identity management, supporting ISO 27001 audit activities.
- Responded to security events and anomalous activity, coordinating with infrastructure and development teams to contain and remediate incidents.
- Automated infrastructure and security operations tasks using PowerShell scripting, reducing manual effort and improving consistency of configuration management.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built end-to-end SIEM and XDR detection coverage in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM across an 8,000-user hybrid environment, integrating endpoint, identity, cloud and network log sources for full kill-chain visibility.
- Authored over 50 KQL detections and analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, reducing false positive volume and significantly improving analyst alert quality.
- Developed 15+ SOAR automation playbooks across Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and CrowdStrike Fusion, automating high-volume alert handling and cutting mean time to respond by an estimated 40%.
- Built out cloud security architecture recommendations for UAL's Azure environment, closing identified gaps in security posture and improving CIS Controls alignment.
- Established a formal threat hunting programme using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and KQL-based hypothesis-driven hunting in Microsoft Sentinel, proactively uncovering threats not caught by automated rules.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)

- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Remote/Hybrid (London/UK)